

Cuba

Ratio: 1:2 **Adopted:** May 20, 1902 **Usage:** National and Civil

“La Estrella Solitaria”—
the Lone Star



*The triangle comes from the
Masonic symbol for equality*

The design is
based on the
US Stars and
Stripes

North America



Cuba, the only communist state in the Americas, was a Spanish colony until 1898, when it was ceded to the USA. It gained independence in 1902.

The flag was designed in 1848 for the liberation movement, which sought to detach Cuba from Spain and make it into a state of the USA. The Lone Star represented another star which would be added to “the splendid North American constellation.”

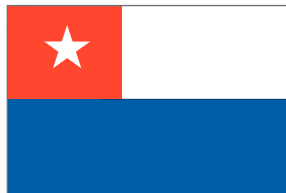
The triangle is derived from the Masonic symbol for equality, while the five stripes stand for the five

provinces of the time. The flag was briefly hoisted in 1850 at Cardenas, but was not officially adopted until 1902, when independence was granted by the USA.

Another flag from the 19th century is that of Carlos Manuel de Céspedes, used by the independence movement of 1868–78. It is now used as the Jack of the Cuban navy.

FLAG OF CÉSPEDES

The flag is like that of Chile with the blue and red reversed



This flag was also modeled on the Stars and Stripes, using the same colors: blue, red, and white and a star in the canton